

AENT – UNIT – IV
BRAND AND CHANNEL STRATEGY &
LEVERAGING TECHNOLOGY

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1. Introduction to Brand

- A **brand** is a name given to a product and/or service such that it takes on an identity by itself. A **brand** name can create and stand for loyalty, trust, faith, premium ness or mass-**market** appeal, depending on how the **brand** is marketed, advertised and promoted.
- The term brand refers to a business and marketing concept that helps people identify a particular company, product, or individual. Brands are intangible, which means you can't actually touch or see them. As such, they help shape people's perceptions of companies, their products, or individuals. Brands often use identifying markers to help create brand identities within the marketplace. They provide enormous value to the company or individual, giving them a competitive edge over others in the same industry. As such, many entities often seek legal protection for their brands by obtaining trademarks.

Key Points of Brand:

- A brand is an intangible marketing or business concept that helps people identify a company, product, or individual.
- People often confuse brands with things like logos, slogans, or other recognizable marks, which are marketing tools that help promote goods and services.
- Brands are considered to be among a company's most important and valuable assets.
- Companies can protect their brands by registering trademarks.
- Types of brands include corporate, personal, product, and service brands.

Concept of Branding:

- The marketing practice of creating a name, symbol or design that identifies and differentiates a product from other products
- An effective brand strategy gives you a major edge in increasingly competitive markets. But what exactly does "branding" mean? Simply put, your brand is your promise to your customer. It tells them what they can expect from your products and services, and it differentiates your offering from that of your competitors. Your brand is derived from who you are, who you want to be and who people perceive you to be.

Elements of Branding:

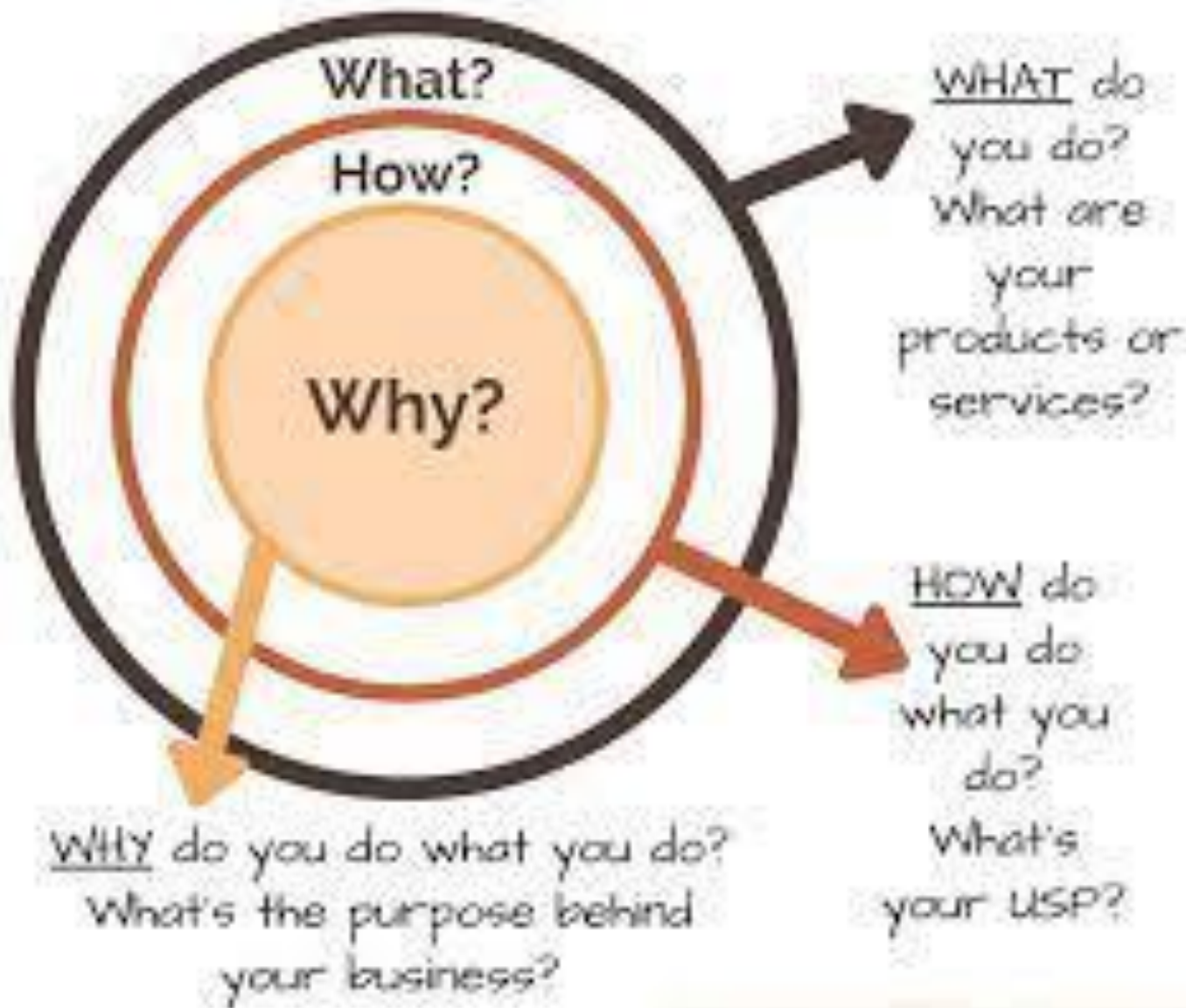
- Get a great logo. Place it everywhere.
- Write down your brand messaging. What are the key messages you want to communicate about your brand? Every employee should be aware of your brand attributes.
- Integrate your brand. Branding extends to every aspect of your business--how you answer your phones, what you or your salespeople wear on sales calls, your e-mail signature, everything.
- Create a "voice" for your company that reflects your brand. This voice should be applied to all written communication and incorporated in the visual imagery of all materials, online and off. Is your brand friendly? Be conversational. Is it ritzy? Be more formal. You get the gist.

- Develop a tagline. Write a memorable, meaningful and concise statement that captures the essence of your brand.
- Design templates and create brand standards for your marketing materials. Use the same color scheme, logo placement, look and feel throughout. You don't need to be fancy, just consistent.
- Be true to your brand. Customers won't return to you--or refer you to someone else--if you don't deliver on your brand promise.
- Be consistent. This tip involves all the above and is the most important tip on this list. If you can't do this, your attempts at establishing a brand will fail.

The Golden Circle

2. Draw the Venture's Golden Circle:

- The **Golden Circle** is an incredibly simple way to both articulate what your business does and define your value proposition to your customers.
- To complete your Golden Circle, you just need to answer 3 questions:
- **Why** – Why should your company exist? What is the ultimate purpose?
- **What** – What do you sell/ what services do you offer?
- **How** – How do you go about your business? What are the processes and beliefs?
- Whether you are a big corporate, startup founder, small business owner; or even a freelancer; this model will help you. And by taking the time to complete it, you'll be in great company with businesses all over the world using this to define how they operate.



The Golden Circle

WHAT

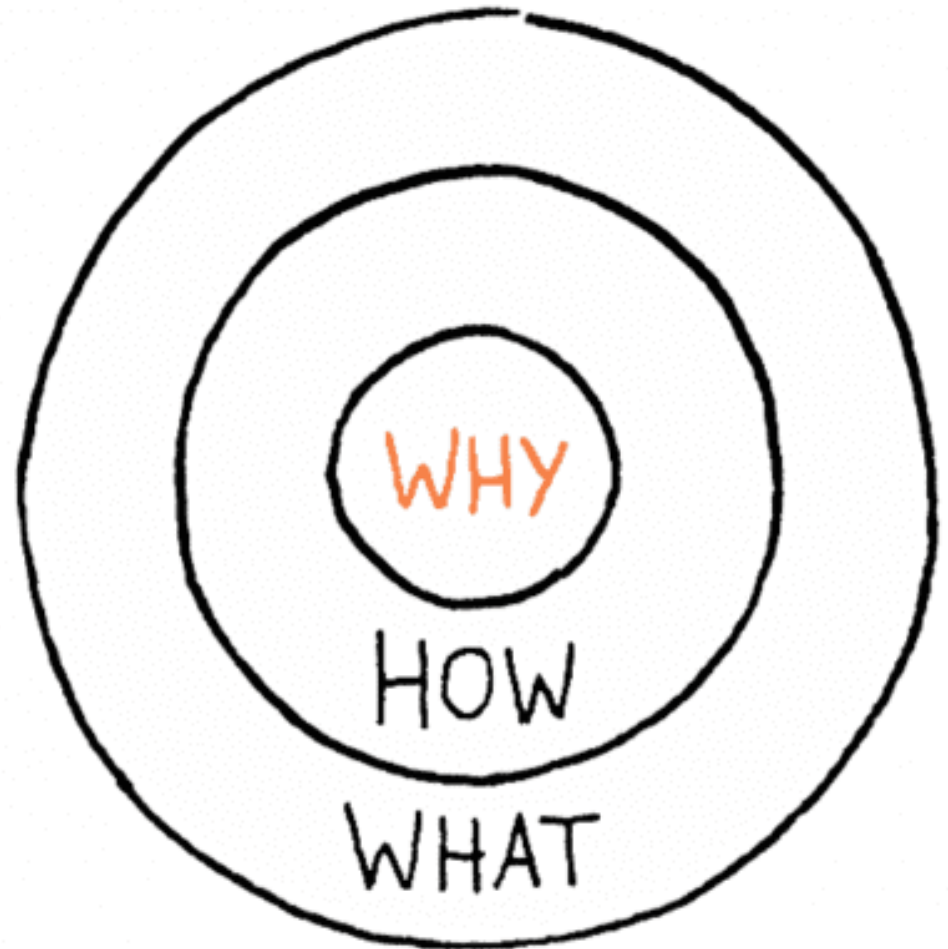
Every organization on the planet knows WHAT they do. These are products they sell or the services

HOW

Some organizations know HOW they do it. These are the things that make them special or set them apart from their competition.

WHY

Very few organizations know WHY they do what they do. WHY is not about making money. That's a result. WHY is a purpose, cause or belief. It's the very reason your organization exists.



BRAND POSITIONING



3. Concept of Positioning:

Positioning defines where your product (item or service) stands in relation to others offering similar products and services in the marketplace as well as the mind of the consumer. Description: A good **positioning** makes a product unique and makes the users consider using it as a distinct benefit to them.

Positioning refers to the place that a brand occupies in the minds of the customers and how it is distinguished from the products of the competitors and different from the concept of brand awareness

Market positioning refers to the process of establishing the image or identity of a brand or product so that consumers perceive it in a certain way. For **example**, a car maker may **position** itself as a luxury status symbol. Whereas a battery maker may **position** its batteries as the most reliable and long-lasting.

Types of Positioning:

- Positioning is broadly classified into three types:
- **1. Functional:** This is used when the brand or products provide solutions to problems and provide benefits to customers. It focuses on the function, benefit or utility that it gives to the customer.
- **2. Symbolic:** This is useful for creating a brand image which helps create brand equity, a sense of social belongingness and ego-identification. It is when a customer has an affection, social connection, ego identification etc with the product.
- **3. Experiential:** This creates sensory and cognitive simulation in the minds of the customer. It is one of the basis of the experiences which a customer can relate to.

Positioning Statement:

- A **positioning statement** is a concise description of your target market as well as a compelling picture of how you want that market to perceive your brand. ... Every product and marketing decision you make regarding your brand has to align with and support your **positioning statement**.
- **Positioning Statements** are brief descriptions of a product/service and how it fulfills the needs of the target market. A good **positioning statement** should, as the name suggests, position the brand, especially in relation to competitor brands.

The four elements of a Brand Positioning Statement



Apple Positioning Statement

For (individuals who want the best personal computer or mobile device), (Apple)

(target)

(brand)

is the (leader of technology industry) that delivers (the most innovative products)

(category)

(point of difference)

so they can (enjoy seamless experiences across all Apple devices & be empowered

(end benefit)

with breakthrough services), because (Apple takes an innovative approach to business

(reason to believe)

best practices, considering the impact our products have on customers & the planet).

OPTIMISM CLARITY
WARMTH

FRIENDLY CHEERFUL
CONFIDENCE

EXCITEMENT YOUTHFUL
BOLD

CREATIVE IMAGINATIVE
WISE

TRUST DEPENDABLE
STRENGTH

PEACEFUL GROWTH
HEALTH

BALANCE NEUTRAL
CALM



4. Create Brand Name & Logo

- **How to Build a Brand**
- Research **your** target audience and **your** competitors.
- Pick **your** focus and personality.
- Choose **your** business **name**.
- Write **your** slogan.
- Choose the look of **your brand** (colors and font).
- **Design your** logo.
- Apply **your branding** across **your** business and evolve it as you grow.

How to Choose a Great Brand Name

- Use the founder or inventor's **name** (Hewlett-Packard)
- Describe what you do (Southwest Airlines)
- Describe an experience or image (Sprint)
- Take a word out of context (Apple)
- Make up a word (Google)

How to Name a Brand in 10 Steps

- Develop Your **Brand** Strategy.
- Research the Market, Competitors, and Consumers.
- Identify the Message Your **Brand** Should Communicate.
- Brainstorm without Judging.
- Create a Short List.
- Trademark and Domain **Name** Availability Search.
- Create a Shorter Short List.
- Develop **Brand** Marketing Mock-ups.

Here are the most important steps to designing a logo: —

- Understand why you need a **logo**.
- Define your brand identity.
- Find inspiration for your **design**.
- Check out the competition.
- Choose your **design** style.
- Find the right type of **logo**.
- Pay attention to color.
- Pick the right typography.



5. Social Media Handle:

How to create a social media marketing strategy

- Set S.M.A.R.T. goals.
- Track meaningful metrics.
- Create audience personas.
- Gather data.
- Conduct a competitive analysis.
- Use **social media** listening.
- Look for impostor accounts.
- Decide which **networks** to use.

S



Specific

M



Measurable

A



Achievable

R



Relevant

T



Time-bound

The Types of Social Media With Examples

- **Social Networks.** Examples: Facebook, LinkedIn.
- **Bookmarking Sites.** Examples: Pinterest, Flipboard, Diggs.
- **Social news.** Examples: Digg.
- **Media Sharing.** Examples: Pinterest, YouTube, Vimeo.
- **Microblogging.**
- **Blog comments and forums.**
- **Social Review Sites.**
- **Community Blogs.**



MARKETING CHANNELS

6. Identify Right Channels:

How to Pick the Best Marketing Channels

- See what others in your industry are doing.
- Read **marketing** blogs and attend industry conferences.
- Only test one new **marketing channel** at a time.
- Set aside a test budget with a designated test window.
- Try different types of content or promotions during this test period.

Before even evaluating specific marketing channel options, marketers must:

- Analyze the customer;
- Establish channel objectives ; and
- Specify distribution tasks.

Once the specific channel tasks have been determined, the evaluation and selection process can begin.

There are four bases for channel alternatives:

- Number of levels;
- Intensity at the various levels;
- Types of intermediaries at each level; and
- Application of selection criterion to channel alternatives.



Leaping ahead with Technology

7. Leaping ahead with Technology:

Startups have an advantage of being agile, ability to change processes and disrupt the industry because they are far more comfortable with letting **technology** take the lead over established large companies who are still learning the ropes. Thus, it is far easier for **startups** to build **technology** run organisations.

Technology gives **small business** owners and their employees the option to work in the office, from home, on the road and even from across the country. Affording **small business** owners the opportunity to hire talent from all over the world, **technology** can help **businesses** gain a competitive edge in the global environment.

It is technology roles that can make or break the success of businesses. Here are some of the roles technology plays in businesses.

- One of the most vital and important roles technology plays in business is the provision of communication.
 - Technology allows you to communicate with your staff and your customers. Without an effective communication system in your business, you cannot be efficient or timely.
- Once you are using technology to communicate and do business the role of security becomes vital.
 - Security in your technology systems protects your company's confidential information.
 - Security in your technology protects your customer's data.
 - It also provides a wall between your unique products and services from your competitors.

- Technology is used for almost all marketing needs in today's business world. Technology which is used for marketing provides
 - targeted markets for analysis.
 - targeted consumer behavior data and their triggers for purchases.
 - targets what advertising works best with customers, and more.
- A business cannot stay competitive without the capacity to research. Businesses need research to keep growing and developing.
 - Technology through its role as a researcher allows businesses to travel the globe and discover new markets.
 - This global research allows businesses to compete with better-defined products and services.
- Technology helps you grow your businesses impact and capacity. Businesses use various technology tools in growing their capacity. Some are as follows;
 - Webinars, Blogs, E-newsletters
 - Virtual meetings and more.

Digital Marketing for



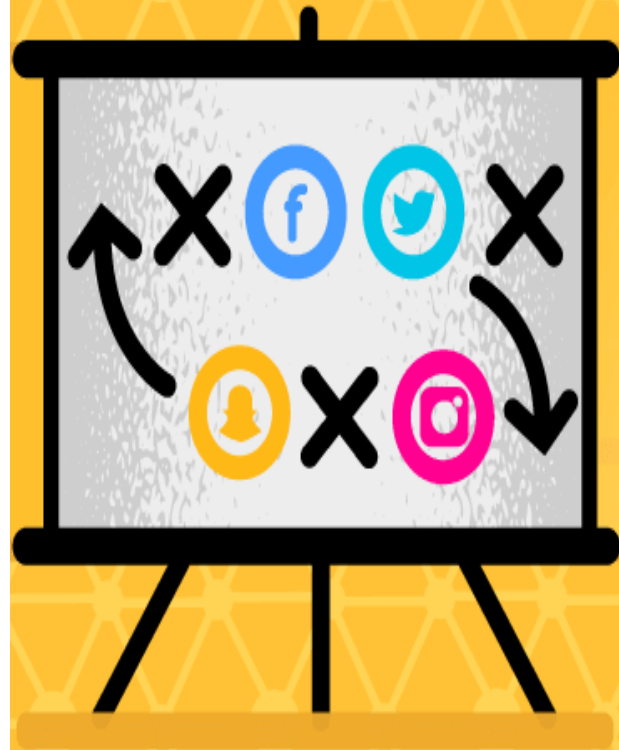
8. Digital Marketing for Startups:

Digital marketing agencies usually charge their clients on a retainer basis, which means the **business** will have a consistent monthly income. Since every **business** has some fixed expenses, having a stable income month on month, makes such an agency a **great business** model. Digital marketing allows startups to:

- Boost their visibility
- Reduce their marketing budget
- Generate leads
- Increase Sales
- Develop a brand awareness
- Increase online conversion rates
- Improve customer engagement

10 Best Digital Marketing Strategies for Startups

1. Email **Marketing**.
2. **Social Media Marketing**.
3. Pay-Per-Click **Marketing** (Google AdWords)
4. Search Engine Optimization.
5. Influencer **Marketing**.
6. Content **Marketing**.
7. Retargeting Ads.
8. Viral **Marketing**.



How to Build A SUCCESSFUL SOCIAL MEDIA Marketing Plan

9. Plan a Social Media Campaign:

Wondering how to plan a social media marketing campaign?

- If you have a new feature coming out, a holiday that you want to capitalize on, or maybe you're releasing a brand new product, there are always plenty of reasons to start a new campaign.
- But in order to make sure your campaign is as successful as possible, you need to plan and strategize the campaign in advance.
- That's why you need a data-driven marketing strategy to help shape the direction of your social media campaign to improve your chances of achieving your goals.
- Smart Insights members are using our social media solutions to create an integrated social media marketing strategy, to increase engagement and boost leads and sales.

8 Steps To Creating A Social Media Campaign That Gets Results

- Understand the goal of the **campaign**.
- Decide how to promote the **campaign** on each channel.
- Create a content calendar for the week/month.
- Create supporting visual content.
- **Schedule** posts.
- Monitor and respond.
- Follow up after the event or promotion, if necessary

HOW DIGITAL COLLABORATION

IN THE WORKPLACE
IMPROVES WORKFLOWS



10. Digital Collaboration:

Digital collaboration is using **digital** technologies for **collaboration**. Dramatically different from traditional **collaboration**, it connects a broader network of participants who can accomplish much more than they would on their own. The **digital collaboration** aims to improve workplace communication, **collaboration**, content management, document management, and information flow across the organization and leads to increased productivity and employee efficiency.

Digital collaboration is the practice of people working together through online means such as software-as-a-solution (SaaS) platforms. Instead of teams only communicating and working together in person, they are able to rely on digital tools to address many of their collaborative needs. Some organisations use digital collaboration to supplement their day-to-day, onsite operations. Others, such as remote-only companies, practice digital collaboration exclusively—making video calls, sharing documents, and managing projects in the cloud.

Digital Collaboration - Features

1. Communication
2. Project Management
3. File Sharing
4. Auditability
5. Access Privileges
6. Security
7. Anonymity



Store Documents Online

11. Store Documents Online: Tools

Next, let's review 10 online document storage solutions you should try out.

1. Dropbox.
2. Google Drive.
3. eversign.
4. Mega.
5. Box.
6. OneDrive.
7. iCloud.

TECHNOLOGY PLATFORM



12. Technology Platforms:

A **technology platform** is an environment for building and running applications, systems and processes. These can be viewed as toolsets for developing and operating customized and tailored services.

- **Technology Platforms.** Amazon Web Services, Microsoft Azure, and Twilio are **examples of Technology Platforms.**
- **Computing Platforms.**
- **Utility Platforms.** ...
- **Interaction Networks.**
- **Marketplaces.**
- **On-demand Service Platforms.**
- **Content Crowdsourcing Platforms.**
- **Data Harvesting Platforms.**



TECHNOLOGY PLAN

For Teaching & Learning

13. Technology Plan

- Technology planning is a process that takes time and resources in order to understand what is appropriate for staff and the organization. Program directors and their management staff may use this resource to further their understanding of what is involved in technology planning.
- Technology planning is a process.
 1. Establish leadership and support.
 2. Assess your resources.
 3. Define your needs.
 4. Explore solutions.
 5. Write the plan.
 6. Get funding.
 7. Implement the plan.

List of Platforms - Wish list

- | | | |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. Operating System | 6. Mobile Platforms | 11. Analytics Platforms |
| 2. Computing Platforms | 7. Web Platforms | 12. Security Platforms |
| 3. Database Platforms | 8. Content Management Systems | 13. Robotics |
| 4. Storage Platforms | 9. Media Platforms | 14. IOT Platforms |
| 5. Application Platforms | 10. API Platforms | 15. AI Platforms |
| | | 16. Game Platforms |



End
of
Unit-IV